

had moved away when I had purchased the place. He thanked me and that was that.

Ultimately, nothing matters. I have thought for some time about the best way in which to explain this spirit in which one's affairs are important but not *all*-important; this spirit in which one can find great success and great wealth and yet retain proper perspective upon one's self and one's affairs—a perspective which is so necessary for peace of mind.

Much of what already has been said in this book is connected with this very important matter. Thus, when one continually *gives* to his fellow men he both shows and feels that his personality is not built merely upon his possessions. I know I have given to the world more than I have taken from it, and this is a great source of contentment to me. Again, the ability to relax, play, live some hours of every day exactly according to your own ideas of pleasurable relaxation—this too brings perspective. I hope by now you have found this out for yourself.

After some testing, however, I have decided to emphasize the phrase: *Ultimately, nothing matters*. When you are grimly involved in getting, when the world seems to exist only within your own circle of activities, when something you have built or bought begins to shut out the sight of the sun—remember, ultimately, nothing matters. Say it aloud: "Ultimately, nothing matters!"

A negative counsel? By no means. *Ultimately, nothing matters*. Everything matters in its time and in its place—and give everything its due. Yet reserve a small corner of the consciousness for the ultimate which maintains perspective, which recognizes the ages as well as today. It makes you more peaceful, it makes you more sure of yourself, and it makes you stronger.

How I found out. Beyond that curtain which men can penetrate with the aid of their five senses, I have some friends who now and then communicate with me.

One night during the first world war, as I was about to retire, I felt a strong urge to turn to my typewriter and write *something*. I was then a confidential counselor to Woodrow Wilson and there were matters of urgent national and international importance crowding my mind. Yet when I had inserted a sheet of paper into the machine and placed my fingers upon its keyboard, only three words came into my con-